$3,000; so take that much out of the $2,000 and let me have $500 for my share."

"No," he said, "we'll split the loss equally. That will make up for our mistake regarding the paperback rights on Pebble in the Sky. But one thing, Isaac."

"Yes, Brad?"

"Leave the business deals to us, will you?"

"Yes, Brad," I said, humbly—and I always have since then.

The incident meant a great deal to me. Doubleday had accepted a loss of $500 rather than cause me to seem to break my word.

My word means a great deal to me and I was in a sweat of gladness that I hadn't allowed myself to be lured away from Double-day, for I didn't know if I could possibly get this kind of treatment elsewhere; and I was incredibly relieved that I had never let myself tell a man capable of such consideration that I was leaving him because I might get more money elsewhere.

I was also glad I had never told him that I had been tempted and had refused, because now I didn't have to feel that Brad's action was a reward. He did it simply because he was a decent person.

At a Hydra Club meeting on June 10, I met Arthur C. Clarke and Groff Conklin for the first time.

Now that The Caves of Steel was finished, I could consider Henry Schuman's proposition seriously. On June 12, I had dinner with him and he introduced me to a Dr. Washton, who was his science adviser.

We decided that I was to do a book on enzymes, hormones, and vitamins, the crucial chemicals of life. This meant the book would have less scope than the popular biochemistry books I had been trying to write for two years, but that was probably a good thing. I had been biting off too much. What's more, the book Schuman was proposing was to be only thirty thousand words long, less than half the length of a novel and even less than the length of a Lucky Starr juvenile.

Dr. Washton also gave me a short lecture on how to write for the early teen-age audience. He told me, for instance, that no sentence must be longer than twenty-five words. 1